



UNIVERSITY OF MORATUWA

Faculty of Information Technology

B.Sc. (Hons) in Information Technology

IS1101- Principles of Management

Tutorial 01

Case 01

NovaByte, a fast-growing AI startup, is developing an innovative virtual assistant powered by machine learning. The company has a small but talented team, high-end servers for AI training, and limited funding. Recently, conflicts have emerged regarding the use of computing resources—developers need more GPU power for AI training, while the cybersecurity team requires strong defenses against cyber threats. Additionally, some employees feel overworked, while others are underutilized. The CEO wants to ensure that all resources—people, technology, and budget—are used wisely without compromising innovation and security.

1. What are the main types of resources in an IT company?
2. Why is it important to manage resources properly?
3. Why is it important to balance employee workload?

Case 02

TechSolutions Inc. is an IT solutions company that provides software development, cloud services, and IT consultancy to businesses of all sizes. The company's mission is to simplify digital transformations and enhance operational efficiency for clients. They have seen steady growth over the past few years, with a focus on innovation and adapting to new technologies such as artificial intelligence and blockchain. However, the organization has faced challenges in aligning its internal teams with long-term business goals and maintaining consistent quality across projects.

1. What are the main goals of TechSolutions Inc. to grow its business?
2. How can TechSolutions make sure all teams work together to achieve their goals?
3. What challenges might TechSolutions face in meeting its goals?

Case 03

TechInnovate Solutions is an innovative IT company that specializes in providing cutting-edge software products and cloud-based solutions to businesses across various industries. The company's flagship offerings include custom software development, enterprise resource planning (ERP) systems, and scalable cloud infrastructure services. Over the past few years, TechInnovate has experienced significant growth, attracting clients from small startups to large enterprises.

However, as the company expands, it faces increasing complexity in managing a growing number of teams, each working on different aspects of product development, customer service, marketing, and business strategy. These teams are located across multiple regions, and their work often overlaps, requiring extensive coordination and communication. The management team, which was initially small and more hands-on, now faces challenges in overseeing day-to-day operations while maintaining long-term strategic vision.

Recognizing these challenges, the management team at TechInnovate Solutions has realized that adopting **Henry Mintzberg's management roles** could help streamline operations, improve coordination, and enhance both internal and external communication. By implementing these roles, TechInnovate hopes to create a more effective management structure that encourages collaboration, innovation, and efficient decision-making.

1. Which of Henry Mintzberg's management roles would be most useful for the CEO of TechInnovate Solutions to focus on?
2. How can TechInnovate's middle managers benefit from the role of "Disseminator" as defined by Mintzberg?
3. Why is the "Entrepreneur" role important for IT companies like TechInnovate Solutions?

Case 04

InnoTech Solutions is a growing software development company providing innovative digital solutions to businesses of all sizes. The company's management structure includes a CEO, project managers, and team leaders working with developers, designers, and support staff.

The **CEO**, Sarah, focuses on the overall vision of the company, setting strategic goals, and building relationships with investors. As the company expands, Sarah works to ensure the company remains on the cutting edge of technology.

John, the Project Manager at InnoTech, oversees various software development projects, ensuring that they are completed on time and within budget. He coordinates with different teams and works closely with the CEO, Sarah, to align project outcomes with the company's strategic objectives. Emma, the Team Leader, leads a group of developers, including Alex and Priya, who are responsible for building and coding the software. Emma ensures that the developers meet deadlines, communicates their needs to John, and fosters collaboration within the team. As the company grows, it is essential for InnoTech to ensure that each level of management—from project management to team leadership and development—has the right skills to keep projects on track, promote innovation, and support the company's growth.

1. What skills should Sarah (the CEO) focus on to help set InnoTech's strategic direction and growth?
2. How can John (the Project Manager) use his skills to coordinate the work of different teams and ensure projects run smoothly?
3. Why is it important for Emma (the Team Leader) and developers like Alex and Priya to have both technical and communication skills?

Case 05

TechStream Innovations is a growing IT services company that specializes in cloud solutions, custom software development, and IT consulting for small and medium-sized businesses. As the company expands, the management team is focused on improving how they handle increasing projects, clients, and employees. Sarah, the CEO of TechStream Innovations, ensures that each department has specific targets to meet by the end of the year. For example, the development team is tasked with launching three new software products within six months. John, the Project Manager, allocates resources by assigning team members to various projects based on their skills and availability, making sure each team has the necessary tools and support to succeed. Emma, the Team Leader, motivates her team by regularly holding meetings to check on progress, celebrate achievements, and provide encouragement when challenges arise. To keep everything on track, the management team uses project management software to monitor deadlines and performance, reviewing progress regularly and making adjustments if any issues or delays occur.

1. Identify the management functions through the case
2. How does Sarah ensure that each department knows what they need to accomplish by the end of the year?
3. How does Emma keep her team motivated and on track throughout the project?